

STARTING UP

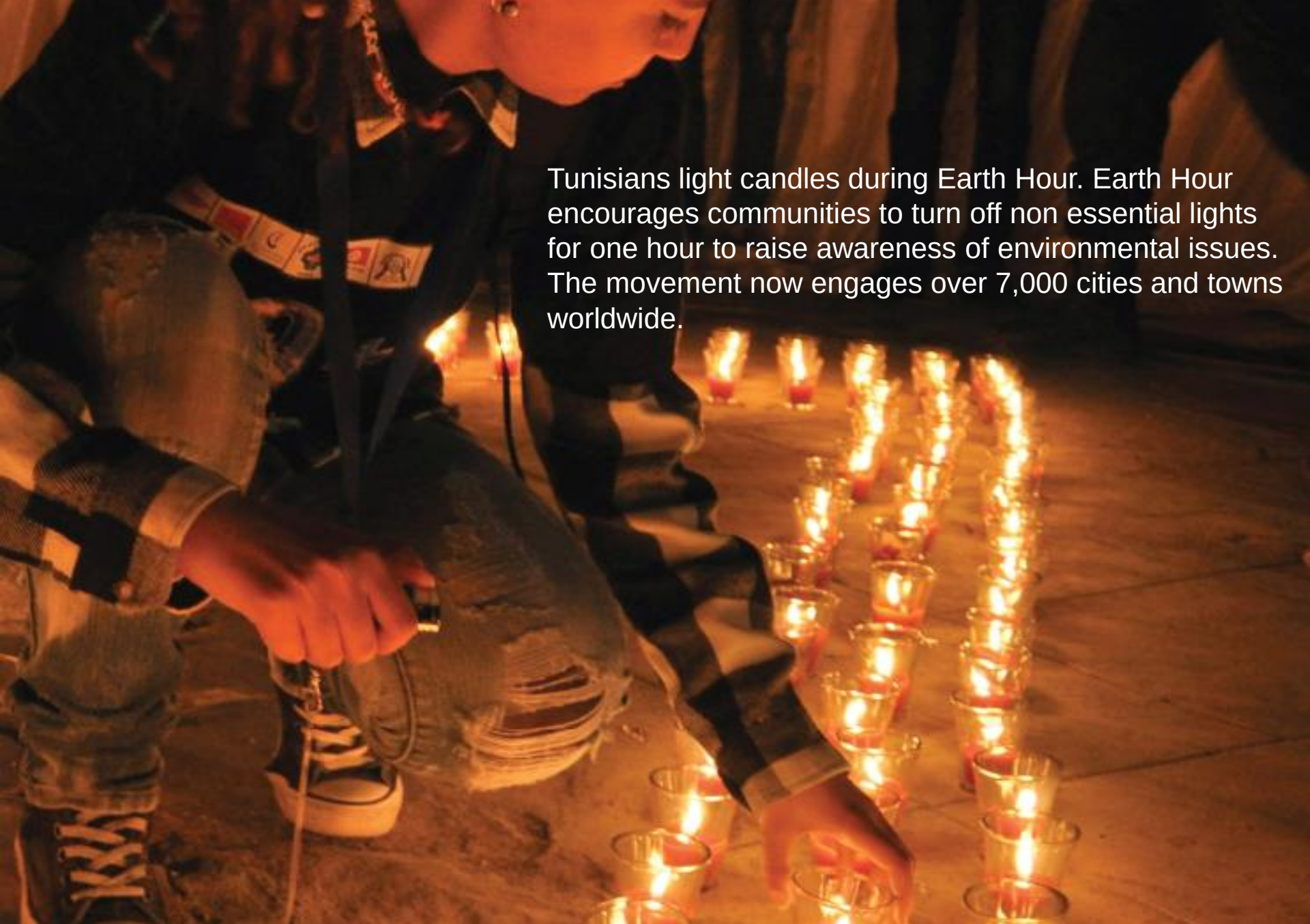
GOALS

IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL:

- Read about the characteristics of successful leaders.
- Learn about the role of followers.
- Explore how different movements start.

THINK AND DISCUSS

1. What do you think the people in the photo are doing? Read the caption to check.
2. What factors make a movement like Earth Hour successful?



Tunisians light candles during Earth Hour. Earth Hour encourages communities to turn off non essential lights for one hour to raise awareness of environmental issues. The movement now engages over 7,000 cities and towns worldwide.

Lesson A

PRE-READING

- A.** Look at the title of the reading passage on page 11. What do you think makes a leader inspiring? List the four most important factors below. Then share your ideas with a partner.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Answers will vary. Possible qualities include: strength, commitment, dedication, purpose, belief, sense of justice, communication skills, public appeal, likeability, etc.

- B.** Look at the picture of Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., and read the caption on this page. Why do you think he is considered a great leader? Discuss your ideas with a partner.

Answers will vary.

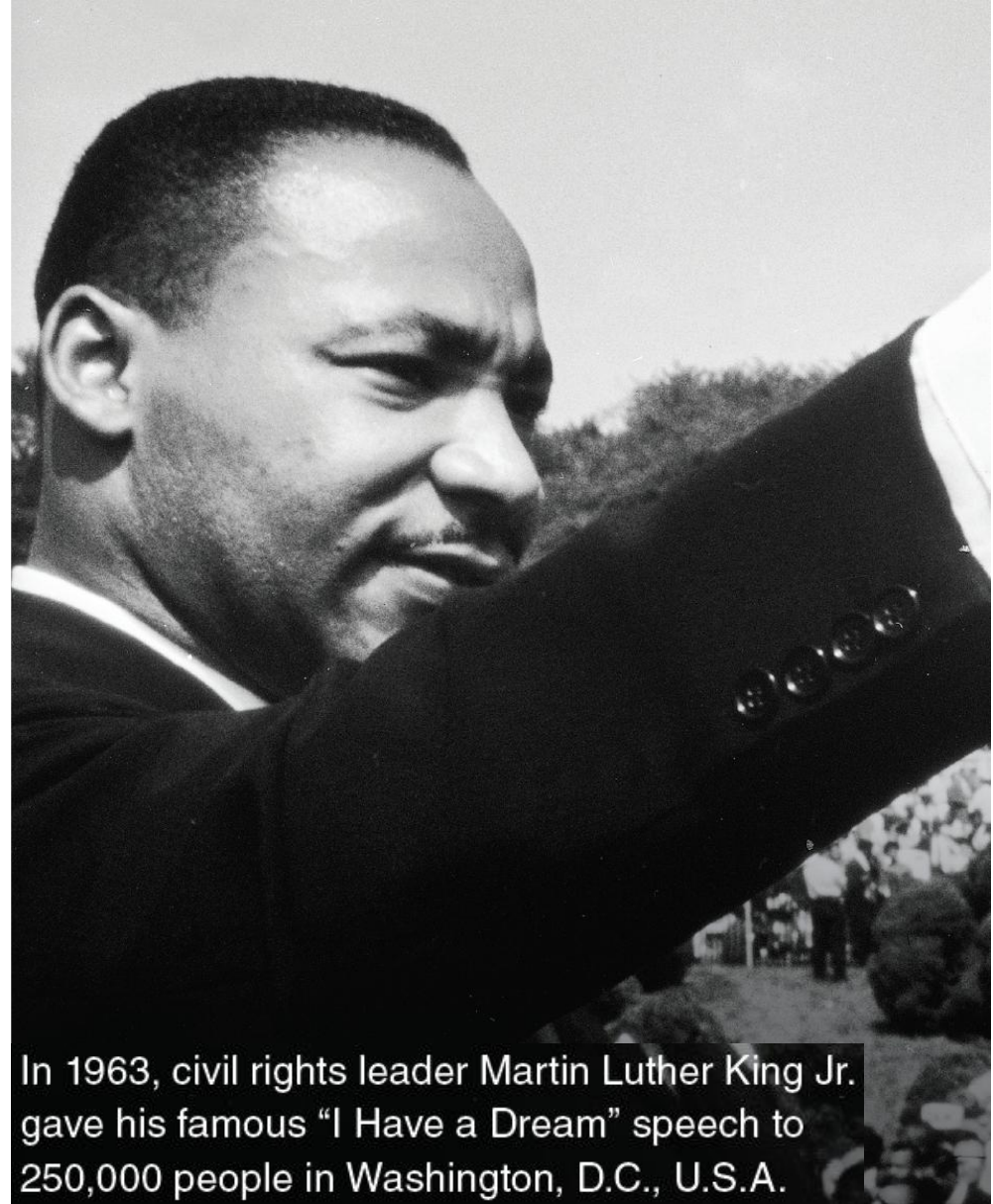
- C.** Look at the title and headings in the reading passage on pages 10–12. Read the first sentence in each paragraph. What do you think the passage is about?

Predictions will vary. The passage is about how leaders inspire us.



INSPIRED LEADERSHIP

In the summer of 1963, 250,000 people **showed up** in Washington, D.C., to hear Martin Luther King Jr. speak. No emails were sent out, and there was no website to check the date. And yet thousands of people went. “How do you do that?” asks Simon Sinek.





INSPIRED LEADERSHIP



FOCUS ON BELIEFS

Sinek, an author and consultant who studies **leadership**, has a theory about why some leaders are able to inspire others to action. He thinks that great leaders, above all, **focus** on what they believe. They answer questions like “What’s my **purpose**? Why does my organization exist? Why do I get out of bed in the morning?” For example, Martin Luther King Jr. **stood out** as a great leader because he told people what he believed—“I have a dream,” he said, not, “I have a plan.” Many people shared his belief that change was possible, and they decided to join him.

If you talk about what you believe, says Sinek, you will **attract** those who share the same beliefs. Most of us are followers, but that does not mean we are unthinking or easily led. Sinek suggests that we don’t follow leaders because we have to, but because we want to. To illustrate this, he points out that thousands of people didn’t turn up for King himself, but for what he—and they—believed in. “It’s what they believed about America,” says Sinek, “that got them to travel in a bus for eight hours to stand in the sun in Washington in the middle of August.”



Organizations, says Sinek, can also inspire followers by focusing on beliefs. The most successful businesses do more than just describe the **features** and benefits of their products. Apple, for instance, communicates its belief in thinking differently and challenging the way things are normally done. This helps to explain, says Sinek, why people stood in line for six hours when the first iPhone came out. They did this not only because of the technology, but because they wanted to be part of a company they believed in. **In other words**, says Sinek, “people don’t buy *what* you do, they buy *why* you do it.”

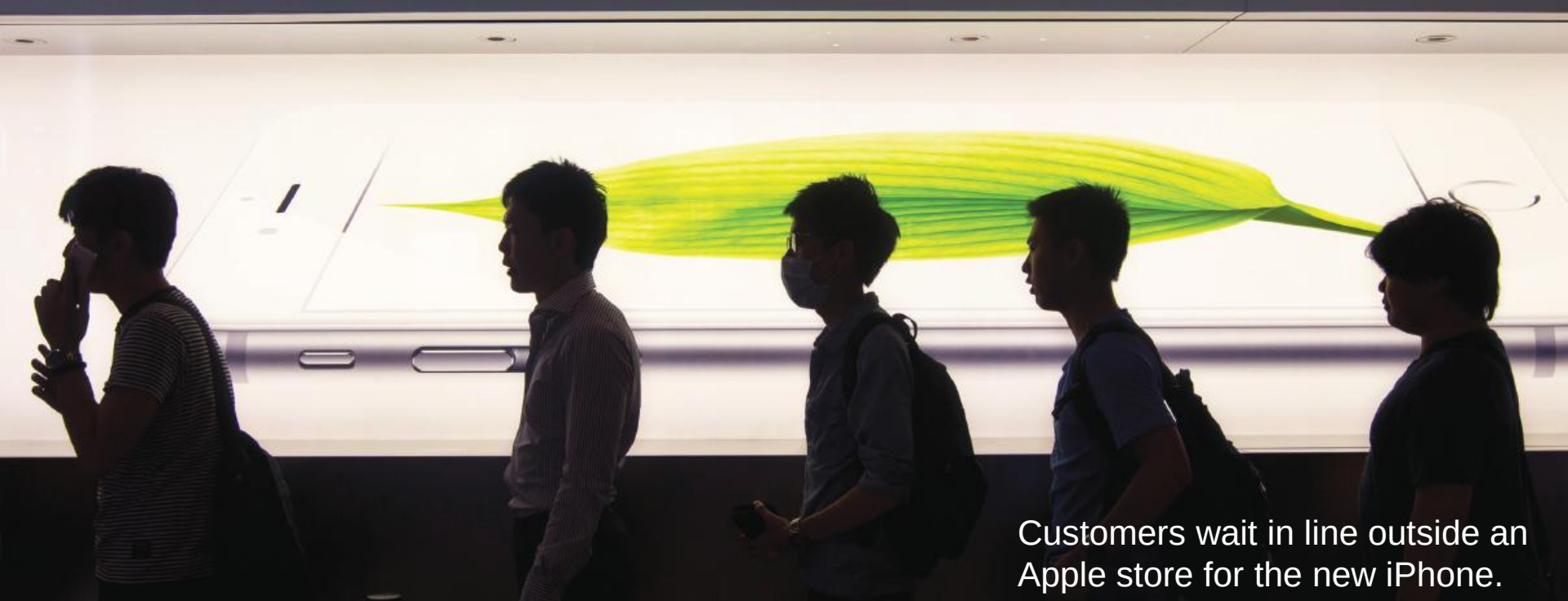
NOT ALL LEADERS INSPIRE

So we make our choices based on why companies and individuals do what they do. Unless we feel a real connection to the leaders in our lives—and share in their beliefs—we won’t follow them. In the end, everyone wants to be part of something they believe in. “Because there are leaders and then there are those who lead,” says Sinek. “Leaders hold a position of power or authority, but those who lead inspire us [. . .] We follow those who lead, not for them but for ourselves.”

unthinking: *adj.* acting or speaking without thinking first

South African leader of the African National Congress movement, Nelson Mandela, salutes a crowd in Amsterdam in 1990.





Customers wait in line outside an Apple store for the new iPhone.

Developing Reading Skills

GETTING THE MAIN IDEAS

1. What is the passage mainly about? Complete the sentence with your own idea. Successful leaders tell people what they believe
2. According to the passage, what is important to followers? Write a sentence with your ideas.
It is important for followers to share the same beliefs as leaders.

IDENTIFYING SUPPORTING IDEAS

Writers usually support their main ideas with extra details, called supporting ideas. The *supporting ideas* make their main ideas clearer, or more persuasive. The following phrases often introduce a supporting idea: “for example,” “for instance,” “to illustrate.”

- A. Scan the passage and underline any words that signal a supporting idea.**

The following words should be underlined:

Paragraph 2: For example

Paragraph 3: To illustrate this

Paragraph 4: for instance

B. Read the main ideas (1–3) below from the passage. Match them with their supporting ideas (a–c).

 b 1. Great leaders focus on what they believe in. [Paragraph 2]

 c 2. People follow leaders who share the same beliefs as them.
[Paragraph 3]

 a 3. Successful businesses focus on beliefs. [Paragraph 4]

a. Apple, for instance, communicates its belief in thinking differently.

b. For example, Martin Luther King Jr. told people “I have a dream,” not “I have a plan.”

c. To illustrate this, he points out that thousands of people didn’t turn up for King himself, but for what he—and they—believed about America.

C. Read the ideas below from the passage. Find and underline the complete sentence in the passage. Then write down if they are main ideas (MI) or supporting ideas (SI).

SI 1. . . . stood in line for six hours . . .

MI 2. . . . attract those that share the same beliefs . . .

SI 3. . . . answer questions like “What’s my purpose?” . . .

SI 4. . . . thousands of people didn’t turn up for King himself . . .

SI 5. . . . No emails were sent out . . .

UNDERSTANDING REFERENCES

Find the following statements in the reading and write down who is being referred to by the underlined word.

1. “They answer questions like ‘What’s my purpose?’”

great leaders

2. “It’s what they believed about America,’ says Sinek . . .”

King’s followers

3. “They did this not only because of the technology . . .”

Apple’s followers

4. “. . . not for them but for ourselves.”

people who lead/people we follow

BUILDING VOCABULARY

A. Circle the correct word or phrase to complete each sentence.

1. Hundreds of people **stood out** / **showed up** at the store at midnight to buy the new iPhone.
2. Good leaders tell people why they are doing something, **in other words** / **stood out**, to explain what they believe.
3. Sinek says we **feature** / **focus** more on a leader's beliefs instead of his or her plans.
4. A business tries to **attract** / **purpose** new customers by offering them better products or services.

B. Match the word or phrase (1–4) to the best definition (a–d).

c 1. leadership

a 2. features

d 3. purpose

b 4. stand out

a. the important parts, qualities, or abilities that something has

b. to appear more impressive than others

c. the ability or power to lead people or an organization

d. a goal or reason

GETTING MEANING FROM CONTEXT

Read the question. Write down your answer, and then discuss your ideas with a partner.

In the passage, the writer says, “Most of us are followers, but that does not mean we are unthinking or easily led.” What does “easily led” mean?

To be “easily led” means that you are quick to follow others, suggesting that you lack independent thought.

CRITICAL THINKING

1. **Reflecting.** Which leaders that you know about have the characteristics described by Sinek?

Answers will vary

2. **Applying.** The passage illustrates how good leadership can benefit businesses. What other areas of life does this idea also apply to? Explain your answer.

Answers will vary. Possibilities include: TV stars, musicians, editors of popular online websites, bloggers.



HOW TO START A MOVEMENT

DEREK SIVERS Entrepreneur, TED speaker

In 1998, Derek Sivers, a professional musician, started selling his music over the Internet. At the time, no one else was selling music this way.

Sivers taught himself programming and created a website to sell his CDs online. Soon, his musician friends saw what a good idea this was and asked him to sell their CDs, too. Sivers then set up CD Baby, an online music store. Within ten years, CD Baby was the biggest online seller of independent music.

Next, Sivers did something that surprised everyone. He sold CD Baby for \$22 million, which he donated to a charity for music education. Sivers has written about and presented the lessons he learned from starting, managing, and selling a business.

In this lesson, you are going to watch Sivers's TED Talk. Use the information above to answer the questions.

1. What was CD Baby?

CD Baby was a company started by Derek Sivers to sell independent music online.

2. What has Sivers written and presented about?

The lessons he learned from starting, managing, and selling a Business.

3. Look at the photo on page 17. Can you guess what the people in the video are doing? What do you think the connection is between the video and leadership?

Guesses will vary. The people are dancing and getting others to join, illustrating the stages of starting a movement.

Sivers's **idea worth spreading** is that while leaders receive the credit for a movement, the followers are the essential driving force.



PART 1

IT TAKES GUTS

PREVIEWING

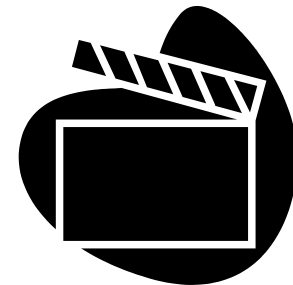
- A.** In his talk, Siverson describes how he thinks a movement starts. Put the steps (a–f) below in the order you think a movement starts.

Guesses will vary. Actual answers are:

- 6 a. Lots of people join in.
- 2 b. One person joins the leader.
- 5 c. Now it's a movement.
- 4 d. Another few people join.
- 1 e. A leader begins a new idea alone.
- 3 f. A second person joins in.

B. Read the excerpt from Sivers's talk. Use the context to match each bold word or phrase (1–5) with a synonym (a–e). Then watch (▶) this segment of Sivers's talk, and check your answers to Exercises A and B.

- 4 a. completely changes
- 3 b. accepts
- 2 c. very important
- 1 d. requires courage
- 5 e. try to be like; copy



“First, of course you know, a leader **(1) needs the guts** to stand out and be ridiculed. But what he’s doing is so easy to follow. So here’s his first follower with a **(2) crucial** role; he’s going to show everyone else how to follow.

Now, notice that the leader **(3) embraces** him as an equal. So, now it’s not about the leader anymore; it’s about them, plural. Now, there he is calling to his friends. Now, if you notice that the first follower is actually an underestimated form of leadership in itself. It takes guts to stand out like that. The first follower is what **(4) transforms** a lone nut into a leader.

And here comes a second follower. Now it’s not a lone nut, it’s not two nuts—three is a crowd, and a crowd is news. So a movement must be public. It’s important to show not just the leader, but the followers, because you find that new followers **(5) emulate** the followers, not the leader.”

to be ridiculed: v. to be laughed at by others in a way that isn’t kind

underestimate: v. to judge something as being less big or important than it really is

nut: n. (informal), a person who is strange or crazy

A. Read the statements and decide whether they are T (True) or F (False).

- T 1. A leader has to be brave and not worry about being laughed at.
- F 2. A movement is formed as soon as one person joins a leader.
- T 3. Those who join a movement later do not need as much courage.

B. According to Sivers, what might be the result of not joining in the movement? Note down your answer and discuss with a partner.

Those who don't join might be ridiculed.

CRITICAL THINKING

Reflecting. Would you have gotten up to dance? Would you have been the leader or a follower? Discuss your answers with a partner.

Answers will vary.

WHO GETS THE CREDIT?

PREVIEWING

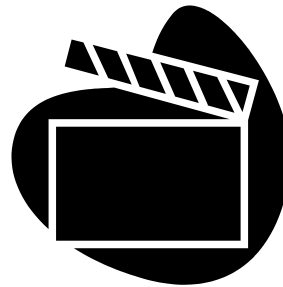
Read the excerpt from Sivers's talk. Underline who Sivers thinks gets the most credit for starting a new movement.

“The biggest lesson, if you noticed—Did you catch it?—is that leadership is over-glorified. That, yes, it was the shirtless guy who was first, and he'll get all the credit, but it was really the first follower that transformed the lone nut into a leader.”

get the credit: v. to receive praise for something you have done or said

RECOGNIZING MAIN IDEAS

A. Watch (▶) the rest of Sivers's talk. Choose which statement best summarizes Sivers's conclusion.



- _____ a. Nobody really understands how movements actually start.
- _____ b. In most cases, followers don't contribute much to starting a movement.
- ☒ _____ c. Leaders are not more important than their followers.

B. Complete the scale to show the level of risk you think was taken by the people in the YouTube video. Then compare your answers with a partner's.

- | | |
|-------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. leader | 4. the rest of the crowd |
| 2. first follower | 5. non-followers |
| 3. next followers | |



Students' points on the chart will vary. General answers are:

- 1. red area*
- 2. red area*
- 3. yellow-orange area*
- 4. blue area*
- 5. yellow-orange area*

GETTING MEANING FROM CONTEXT

Read the excerpt below from Sivers's talk. Then write down your answer to the question.

“So, notice that, as more people join in, it's less risky. So those that were sitting on the fence before, now have no reason not to. . . . Now we've got momentum. This is the tipping point. Now we've got a movement.”

What do “sitting on the fence” and “the tipping point” mean? How else could you express these ideas?

People who are “sitting on the fence” are undecided about whether to join or not. “The tipping point” refers to the moment that a new movement or trend becomes popular.

IDENTIFYING TONE AND ATTITUDE

Work with a partner. What do you think Sivers's attitude is toward his topic? How would you describe his tone during the talk? Explain your answer.

_____ 1. serious

_____ 2. neutral

_____ ✓ 3. humorous

Sivers uses a humorous tone to communicate his ideas about how movements are made.

CRITICAL THINKING

Synthesizing. How do Sivers's ideas about leadership compare with Sinek's in Lesson A? What are the lessons for leaders? What are the lessons for you? Note down your answers and then discuss with a partner.

Both Sivers and Sinek talk about the importance of the role of followers. Both point out that followers are making their own choices when joining a leader. Sinek talks about how followers must already share the same beliefs as their leader while Sivers explains that followers, especially the early ones, might actually do more to lead the movement than the leader.

EXPLORE MORE

Watch another TED Talk by Derek Sivers called “Keep your goals to yourself” at TED.com. What does he mean by “a social reality”? Do you agree with him? Share your opinions with your class.

Project



The Live Aid concert in 1985, a movement started by two pop singers, benefited people suffering from famine in Africa.

Project

A. Work with a partner. You are going to describe how movements are created.

1. With your partner, choose from the following movements:
 - The evolution of rap music
 - The rise of street art
 - Slow food
 - A movement where you live
2. Research the movement. Try to find answers to the following questions:
 - Did many people follow this movement at the very beginning?
 - What was the tipping point? In other words, when did the movement start to be popular?
 - Is this movement still popular today? Why, or why not?
 - Has it changed over time? If so, how?

Project

3. Create a two-minute presentation. Include a timeline to show how this movement was created.

B. Work with two other pairs. Give your presentations. As you listen to the other presentations, take notes on the following questions:

- Were these movements created in similar or different ways?
- Who do you think was more important in these movements: the leaders or the followers? Why?
- What beliefs did the leaders of the movements communicate?

EXPLORE MORE

Watch more TED Talks on leadership. Search for the “How Leaders Inspire” playlist at TED. com. What kinds of people become leaders? Which ones failed? Share what you learn with your class.

Part 1

So, ladies and gentlemen, at TED we talk a lot about leadership and how to make a movement. So let's watch a movement happen, start to finish, in under three minutes and dissect some lessons from it.

First, of course you know, a leader needs the guts to stand out and be ridiculed. But what he's doing is so easy to follow. So here's his first follower with a crucial role; he's going to show everyone else how to follow.

Now, notice that the leader embraces him as an equal. So, now it's not about the leader anymore; it's about them, plural. Now, there he is calling to his friends. Now, if you notice that the first follower is actually an underestimated form of leadership in itself. It takes guts to stand out like that. The first follower is what transforms a lone nut into a leader.

And here comes a second follower. Now it's not a lone nut, it's not two nuts—three is a crowd, and a crowd is news. So a movement must be public. It's important to show not just the leader, but the followers, because you find that new followers emulate the followers, not the leader.

Now, here come two more people, and immediately after, three more people. Now we've got momentum. This is the tipping point. Now we've got a movement. So, notice that, as more people join in, it's less risky. So those that were sitting on the fence before, now have no reason not to. They won't stand out, they won't be ridiculed, but they will be part of the in-crowd if they hurry. So, over the next minute, you'll see all of those that prefer to stick with the crowd because eventually they would be ridiculed for not joining in. And that's how you make a movement.

Part 2

But let's recap some lessons from this. So first, if you are the type, like the shirtless dancing guy that is standing alone, remember the importance of nurturing your first few followers as equals so it's clearly about the movement, not you. Okay, but we might have missed the real lesson here.

The biggest lesson, if you noticed—Did you catch it? —is that leadership is over-glorified. That, yes, it was the shirtless guy who was first, and he'll get all the credit, but it was really the first follower that transformed the lone nut into a leader. So, as we're told that we should all be leaders, that would be really ineffective.

If you really care about starting a movement, have the courage to follow and show others how to follow. And when you find a lone nut doing something great, have the guts to be the first one to stand up and join in. And what a perfect place to do that, at TED.

Thanks.